

HERMAN BOOCK

Product Leader & Builder

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SUMMARY

Senior Product Leader/Exco member with a proven track record of scaling impactful B2B and B2C SaaS platforms. Known for turning user insight into scalable innovation and building high-performing teams that deliver results. I bring a human-centered, data-informed approach to product strategy, grounded in a unique academic background in Mathematics and Psychology.

Currently leading product strategy and execution at JOBJACK, a fast-growing recruitment platform helping over 6 million South Africans find employment. I thrive in startup-to-scaleup environments, drive go-to-market success, and foster alignment across product, design, engineering, and business leadership.

Outside of work, I am a husband, friend and a lifelong learner who finds energy in spending quality time with loved ones. Whether it's watching a show, going for a ride on my motorbike, or exploring new places, I try (my best) to live in every moment. I believe that stepping outside of your comfort zone (physically and mentally) helps build character, creativity, and a strong sense of purpose.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Product Strategy & Execution:** Agile Roadmapping, Prioritization, OKRs, Go-to-Market Strategy and Product Strategy (Favouring the playing to win framework)
 - **Team Leadership:** Cross-functional Alignment, Coaching, Team Scaling, Hiring
 - **User Insights & Research:** NPS, JTBD (Why users choose products), Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Surveys
 - **Data-Driven Decisions:** SQL, Power BI, Dashboards, KPIs
 - **Stakeholder Engagement:** Executive Communication, Investor Relations, Product Evangelism
 - **Tech Enablement:** Automation Tools, AI-Powered Products, Rapid prototyping
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PROFESSIONAL EXPRIENCE

Head of Product | JOBJACK (2021 - Present)

Focus Areas:

- Define and drive the product vision and roadmap, aligning with business goals, market trends, and user needs in the entry-level recruitment space.
- Establish product success metrics and lead retro-analysis to continuously optimize based on data and user feedback.
- Lead end-to-end product lifecycle, from discovery to delivery. Prioritizing features, ensuring UX excellence and coordinating technical execution across teams.
- Build and scale high-performing cross-functional product teams (Product Managers, Designers and previously QA and Data), fostering a culture of ownership, experimentation and continuous learning.
- Oversee the Customer Support team to ensure high-quality resolution of user issues and reinforce a seamless user journey.
- Lead the go-to-market strategy to drive adoption, engagement and monetization across both B2B and B2C segments.
- Implement internal product reporting and data visualizations to support data-driven decision-making across the business.

Key Achievements:

- Scaled user base from 300,000 to 6.2 million (continuously growing).
- Increased monthly appointment rate from 80 to over 2,500.
- Optimized account manager capacity, automating over 98% of manual tasks.
- **Solution Impact on Customers:**
 - 56% reduction in staff-turnover by ensuring best fit candidates are hired
 - 6% increase in candidate performance (Retail sales figures)
 - 68% reduction in disciplinarys
 - Monitized a supporting ed-tech platform, diversifying revenue streams with a passive MRR increase of 2%
- **Key Projects:**
 - **Series B Funding Success** – Led usability testing, user interviews, and NPS research, helping secure \$2.5M in funding.
 - **Vodacom NXT LVL Get A Gig Platform** – Oversaw product development and implementation, reaching 300 000 job seekers in the first 3 months.
 - **Psychometric Assessment Battery Development** – Researched and built a collection of psychometric assessment indicating job fit potential for the South African market, with over 3 800 000 completed assessments.
 - **JOBJACK Lite** – Championed (planned, designed and tested) a PAYU version of the enterprise solution catering to the SMME market that launched in 2026 (currently in beta)
 - **AI Lead Features** – By implementing AI into core feature sets we've improved matching algorithms by 18%, introduced RSA first analysis on the entry-level scale and made verification and validation affordable and scalable.
- **JOBJACK Awards:**
 - Winner, Western Cape Innovation Awards (Workforce & Human Capital) – 2026
 - Winner, Africa Tech Festival (Startup Category) – 2024

- Winner, JOBJACK Future Trust Awards – 2024
- Winner, JOBJACK SCZA Startup & Investor (Future of Work) – 2023
- Finalist, Africa Tech Festival (Startup of the Year) – 2023
- Finalist, Excellus SaaS of the Year (Best SaaS Targeting Enterprises) – 2022
- Winner, Small Business Award (Tech Industry) – 2022

Product Owner | Nebula (2020 - 2021)

Focus Areas:

- Owned the roadmap for multiple SaaS products (OneView, Stactize, Surge Identity).
- Led feature development, UX improvements, and product-market fit initiatives.
- Acted as a bridge between stakeholders and development teams, ensuring strategic alignment.
- Researched and implemented metered billing for Azure Marketplace solutions.

Key Achievements:

- Successfully led a complete redesign of OneView.
- Onboarded Stactize's first client, establishing a scalable onboarding process that reduced activation time by over 70%.
- **Key Project:**
 - **Nebula OneView Redesign** – Led a complete UI/UX revamp, improving usability and stability and reducing error rate & support queries.
 - **Azure Marketplace Billing for Stactize** – Developed metered billing, onboarding the first client and creating an additional revenue stream.

Data Analyst | Nebula (2019 - 2020)

- Automated reporting and data visualization, improving efficiency and saving multiple hours per week.
- Conducted cost-saving analysis for JSE-listed clients, delivering multi-million Rand savings.
- Developed data-driven decision-making models (Data usage Trends), improving forecasts and reducing escalations for customers.

Entrepreneurial Experience: Co-Founder | HS Sorting (2018 - 2019)

- Developed & implemented a cost-effective solution for quality control in glass manufacturing.
- Scaled team from 8 to 19 certified sorters.
- Implemented process optimizations (Sorting line and Inspection processes) that increased productivity by over 500%, resulting in quicker turn-around times for customers.

System & Data Analyst | Quintica (2019)

- Supported a large-scale Remedy upgrade project.
 - Developed automation test solutions.
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EDUCATION

University of Cape Town — Product Management (2022)

Harvard Business School Online — Business Analytics (2019)

Stellenbosch University — BSc Mathematical Sciences, Operations Research (2016)

Stellenbosch University — BSc Human Life Sciences with Psychology (2015)

TOOLKIT

- **Product Strategy & Roadmapping:** Agile, Lean, OKRs, KPIs
 - **Data Analytics & Automation:** SQL, Power BI, VBA, Excel
 - **User Research & Testing:** NPS, Heatmaps, Surveys, Usability Tests, A/B Testing
 - **Design & UX:** Wireframing, User Flows, Figma Collaboration
 - **AI & Custom GPT Development:** 800+ Custom GPT engagements, automation tools, multiple lovable sites and prototypes
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REFERENCES

Available on request